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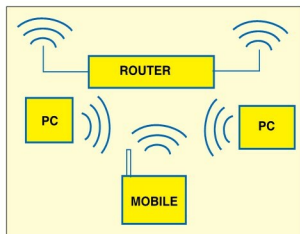


Fig. 2: Wi-Fi network

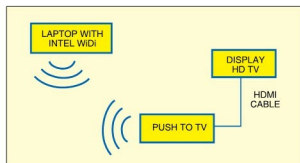


Fig. 3: WiDi Interface

the information to the Internet using a physical wired Ethernet connection. The process also works in reverse, with the router receiving information from the Internet, translating it into a radio signal and sending it to the computer's wireless adaptor.

Wi-Fi radios can transmit and receive radio waves, converting 1's and 0's into radio waves and then back into 1's and 0's. But these have a few notable differences from other radios. They transmit at a frequency of 2.4 GHz or 5 GHz, which is considerably higher than the frequencies used for cell-phones, walkie-talkies and televisions. A higher frequency allows the signal to carry more data. The radios use 802.11 networking standards, which come in many versions.

Several devices can use one router to connect to the Internet as long as they have wireless adaptors. This connection is convenient, virtually invisible and fairly reliable. However, if the router fails or if too many people try to use high-bandwidth applications at the same time, users can experience

interference or lose their connections.

A wireless router uses an antenna to send signals to wireless devices and a wire to send signals to the Internet. This is a single unit that contains a port to connect to your cable or DSL modem. A wireless access point is used if several computers are to be networked or Ethernet network is to be replaced. Deployment of resources in a Wi-Fi network is shown in Fig. 2.

802.15, another wireless standard with a slightly different number, is used for wireless personal area networks. It covers a very short range and is used for Bluetooth technology.

WiMax, also known as 802.16, combines the benefits of broadband and wireless and provides high-speed wireless Internet over very long distances.

WiDi. WiDi is Intel's Wireless Display Interface technology that addresses the needs of home theatre and multimedia PC markets by enabling wireless connectivity of a notebook over HDMI to an HDTV. Using standard 802.11 wireless technologies for data transmission, it requires a laptop PC based on select 2010 Intel Core processors, Intel HD graphics and Intel Centrino wireless with Intel MyWiFi Technology. The laptop needs to have Intel Wireless Display software and also an adaptor to receive the signals from the PC and display them on the TV. This adaptor is connected to the TV via either HDMI or standard AV cables. The arrangement is shown in Fig. 3.

Answers compiled by Col (Retd) N.C. Pande.

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